

# SRI VAISHNAVA DOSSIER: BATCH 1

## (EARLY AZHWARS)

### BATCH EXECUTIVE SUMMARY TABLE

| Personality Name        | Tamil Month / Nakshatram        | Avathara Sthalam (Birthplace)             | Divine Amsam                 | Primary Literary / Philosophical Contribution                                                                           |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Poigai Azhwar</b>    | Aippasi / Thiruvonam (Sravanam) | Kanchipuram (Sardhotha Poigai, Tiruvekka) | Kaumodaki (Divine Mace/Gada) | <i>Mudhal Thiruvanthadhi</i> (100 Pasurams); Ignited the Bhakti movement using <i>Jnana Deepam</i> (Lamp of Knowledge). |
| <b>Bhoothath Azhwar</b> | Aippasi / Avittam (Dhanishta)   | Thirukadalmallai (Mamallapuram)           | Kaustubham (Divine Gem)      | <i>Irاندam Thiruvanthadhi</i> (100 Pasurams); Fuelled spiritual vision through <i>Anbu Deepam</i> (Lamp of Devotion).   |
| <b>Pey Azhwar</b>       | Aippasi / Sadayam (Shatabhisha) | Thirumayilai (Mylapore, Chennai)          | Nandaka (Divine Sword)       | <i>Moondram Thiruvanthadhi</i> (100 Pasurams); Attained direct vision ( <i>Thirukanden</i> )                            |

|                             |               |                                     |                                   |                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                             |               |                                     |                                   | of the Divine Couple.                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Thirumazhisai Azhwar</b> | Thai / Magham | Thirumazhisai (Jagannatha Kshetram) | Sudarshana (Divine Discus/Chakra) | <i>Nanmugan Thiruvanthadhi (96 Pasurams) &amp; Thiruchanda Viruttham (120 Pasurams); Established uncompromising Monotheism (Ekantha Bhakti).</i> |

# 1. POIGAI AZHWAR

(Kanchi Divya Desam Avathara Mudhal Azhwar, Sarovara Muni, Poigaiyar)

## Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Poigai Azhwar, Sarovara Muni, Poigaiyar, Kanchipuram Avathara Mudhal Azhwar.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
  - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Aippasi (Ashvin/Kartika transition)
  - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Thiruvonam (Sraavanam)
  - **Tithi & Paksham:** Dvapara Yuga terminal phase (traditionally 4203 BCE), Sukla Paksha Navami.
- **Geographic Origins:**
  - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Kanchipuram (Near Tiruvekka / Sonnavanna Vannan Temple pond)
  - **Current District & State:** Kanchipuram District, Tamil Nadu
  - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Tiruvekka (Yathothkari Perumal Temple) & Sri Yathothkari Swamy Devasthanam, Kanchipuram.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
  - **Divine Amsam:** Kaumodaki (The Divine Mace/Gada of Lord Sriman Narayana)
  - **Historical Period:** Early Sangam / Post-Sangam Transition Period (Traditionally Dvapara Yuga; modern academic consensus places him c. 5th–6th Century CE).
  - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Bhoothath Azhwar, Pey Azhwar, Pallava Rulers of Kanchi.

## Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

## 2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Ayoni Sambhava Birth:** Discovered inside a fresh golden lotus in the temple tank (*Sardhotha Poigai*) of Tiruvekka, Kanchipuram → **Spiritual Realization:** Natural enlightenment (*Ayoni Sembhavatvam*) free from embryonic contamination; direct contemplation of Para Vasudeva → **The Divine Encounter at Thirukoilur:** Meeting Bhoothath and Pey Azhwar in the dark corridor (*Dehali*) of Thirukoilur during a torrential storm → **Sankirtana Composition:** Lighting the *Jnana Deepam* (Lamp of Knowledge) via the first verse of *Mudhal Thiruvanthadhi* → **Perpetual Wanderings & Mukthi:** Wandering through major North and South Indian Divya Desams, spreading Viśiṣṭādvaita precursor tenets before merging into the divine radiance of the Lord.

## 2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Unlike ordinary mortal beings subject to *Garbha Vasam* (confinement in a womb), Poigai Azhwar was an *Ayoni Sambhava* (one not born of a womb). He manifested spontaneously on a divine golden lotus blossoming in the pond adjacent to the Tiruvekka Yathothkari Perumal Temple in Kanchipuram. Blessed with *Ayathna Jnana* (effortless divine knowledge) from the instant of his manifestation, he required no earthly guru to instruct him in the Vedas, Upanishads, or Agamas. He spent his early years immersed in intense *Yogic* trance (*Samadhi*) along the banks of the sacred water bodies of Kanchipuram.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** His primary *kainkaryam* was mental and vocal (*Manasa* and *Vachika*)—weaving garlands of Tamil verse (*Thamizh Maalai*) to elucidate the esoteric truths of the Sanskrit Vedas. He traversed the length and breadth of Tamilakam, visiting holy shrines without establishing permanent residence, living as an ascetic completely detached from secular affairs.
- **Miracles & Historical Events:** The central event in the life of Poigai Azhwar—and indeed the foundational moment of the Azhwar *prabandha* tradition—is the divine encounter at Thirukoilur (*Thirukkovilur Dehali Anubhavam*). Seeking shelter from a fierce, thunderous storm, Poigai Azhwar entered the narrow front corridor (*Dehali*) of a small residence in Thirukoilur. The space was barely large enough for one person to lie down. Shortly thereafter, Bhoothath Azhwar arrived seeking refuge. Poigai Azhwar welcomed him, remarking, "One person can lie down; two can sit." Moments later, Pey Azhwar arrived. They adjusted once more, noting, "Two can sit; three can stand." As the three saints stood together in pitch darkness, an overwhelming, invisible fourth presence pressed tightly against them. Recognizing the supernatural weight and divine fragrance, Poigai Azhwar realized that Sriman Narayana Himself had entered the corridor to enjoy the company of His highest devotees. To reveal this unseen guest, Poigai Azhwar lit the material universe as a lamp using the power of verse.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Poigai Azhwar recognized Sriman Narayana as his sole ultimate Acharya (*Narayana Parabrahma*). He functioned as an early guru-figure to Thirumazhisai Azhwar, who was deeply influenced by the three Mudhal Azhwars during his spiritual transition from various philosophical systems back to Vaishnavism.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Having fulfilled his divine mission of initiating the Dravida Veda era, Poigai Azhwar absorbed his physical form into the supreme light (*Param Jyothi*)

of Sriman Narayana, concluding his earthly manifestations alongside Bhoothath and Pey Azhwar.

#### 💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Miraculous Dehali of Thirukoilur**

The narrow corridor (*Dehali*) of Thirukoilur remains the spiritual birthplace of Sri Vaishnava devotional literature. When Sriman Narayana pressed against the three Mudhal Azhwars in total darkness, it was not out of constraint, but *Saulabhya* (divine accessibility)—the Supreme Lord seeking closeness with His devotees. The lighting of the lamp of wisdom by Poigai Azhwar transformed the dark room into an illumination of the entire Cosmos.

### Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
  - *Tamil Works: Mudhal Thiruvanthadhi* (100 Pasurams composed in *Iyalpa / Nerisai Venba* meter).
  - *Sanskrit / Manipravala Impact:* His verses served as the primary foundation for later commentators like Periyavachan Pillai and Nampillai to establish Viśiṣṭādvaita ontology.
- **Quantified Output:** Exactly 100 Pasurams linked sequentially using the *Andhadhi* poetic feature (where the last word/syllable of one verse forms the opening of the next).
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Tiruvekka (Kanchipuram), Thirukoilur (Tirukkovilur Ulagalantha Perumal), Thiruvengadam (Tirupati), Thirupparkadal (Milk Ocean), Paramapadam (Celestial Abode).
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Pioneered the *Dravida Veda* tradition by proving that high philosophical truths (*Vedanta*) can be fully articulated in the vernacular Tamil language. He set the precedent for using poetic meter as a tool for contemplative *Bhakti-Yoga*.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core:** Characterized by **Jnana-Garbha Bhakti** (Devotion rooted in profound intellectual and cosmological awareness). His philosophy highlights *Karanatvam* (Sriman Narayana as the cosmic Cause) and *Saulabhya* (His supreme accessibility).

### Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

#### Verse 1: Mudhal Thiruvanthadhi, Pasuram 1 (*Vaiyam Thagaliyaga*)

| Text Layer                       | Content                                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Original Script ( <i>Tamil</i> ) | வையந் தகளியா வார்கடலே<br>நெய்யாக<br><br>வெய்ய கதிரோன் விளக்காக - செய்ய<br><br>சுடராழியான் அடிக்கே சூட்டினேன்<br>சொன்ன மாலை<br><br>இடராழி நீங்குகவே யென்று |

|                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Roman Transliteration</b>        | <p><i>Vaiyam thagaliyaga var kadale neyyaga</i></p> <p><i>Veyya kadiron vilakkaga - seyya</i></p> <p><i>Sudarazhiyan adikke suttinen sonna maalai</i></p> <p><i>Idarazhi neengugave yendru</i></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Literal Word-by-Word Meaning</b> | <p><b>Vaiyam:</b> Earth/Universe; <b>Thagaliyaga:</b> as the lamp bowl; <b>Var kadale:</b> expanding ocean; <b>Neyyaga:</b> as the ghee; <b>Veyya kadiron:</b> hot/radiant sun; <b>Vilakkaga:</b> as the burning wick/blaze; <b>Seyya:</b> red/luminous; <b>Sudar azhiyan:</b> Lord holding the glowing Discus; <b>Adikke:</b> at His divine feet; <b>Suttinen:</b> I have offered/adorned; <b>Sonna maalai:</b> garland of words (verses); <b>Idar azhi:</b> ocean of miseries/samsara; <b>Neengugave yendru:</b> so that it may be eradicated entirely.</p> |

### Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopa Jnanam):** Poigai Azhwar constructs a cosmic lamp to dispel both physical darkness in the corridor of Thirukoilur and spiritual darkness (*Ajnana*) in human minds. The Earth represents the container of human experience, the oceans symbolize the boundless oil of love/samsaric reality, and the Sun represents the concentrated light of intellect.
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** The verse establishes Srīman Narayana as the *Koyil* (abode) and ultimate master of the Cosmos (*Seshin*). By addressing the Lord as *Sudarazhiyan* (the wielder of the Chakarathazhwar/Discus), he identifies the Supreme Being (*Para Tattva*) who actively removes obstacles (*Virodhi Nivarana*) for the Jiva.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Periyavachan Pillai in his commentary highlights that this verse demonstrates *Paroksha Jnana* (indirect knowledge elevated through devotion). The garland of words (*Sonna Maalai*) offered at the Lord's feet is non-different from flower garlands, establishing the doctrine that linguistic praise composed with devotion is an essential form of *Kainkaryam*.

## Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

### 5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Ardha Padmasana* (Half-lotus posture) or standing in *Anjali Mudra* within the Thirukoilur triad representation.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** *Jnana Mudra* (index finger touching thumb, signifying the union of Jiva and Paramatma) on the right hand, with the left hand resting on the lap or

folded in prayer (*Anjali*).

- **Garments & Embellishments:** Simple white ascetic loincloth (*Vesti*), prominent *Urdhva Pundra* (holy white clay marks) on twelve places of the body, adorned with sacred *Tulasi* beads and a lotus-seed garland.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At the Tiruvekka shrine in Kanchipuram, Poigai Azhwar's *Moolavar* idol depicts him in a contemplative, meditative pose next to the temple tank, radiating serene *Sattvic* intensity.

## 5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Poigai Azhwar Mudhal Thiruvanthadhi Upanyasam Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Mudhal Azhwargal Vaibhavam Karunakarachariar"
- "Thirukoilur Dehali Anubhavam Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

## 5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** [<http://www.dravidaveda.org>](<http://www.dravidaveda.org>)
- **Project Madurai Texts:** [<https://www.projectmadurai.org>](<https://www.projectmadurai.org>)
- **Koyil Archival Library:** [<https://koyil.org>](<https://koyil.org>)

# 2. BHOOTHATH AZHWAR

(*Thirukadalmallai Avathara Mudhal Azhwar, Mallai Natha, Bhoothathar*)

## Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Bhoothath Azhwar, Mallai Natha, Bhoothathatthan, Second Among the Mudhal Azhwars.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
  - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Aippasi
  - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Avittam (Dhanishta)
  - **Tithi & Paksham:** Dvapara Yuga terminal phase (One day after Poigai Azhwar), Sukla Paksha Dasami.
- **Geographic Origins:**
  - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Thirukadalmallai (Mamallapuram / Mahabalipuram)
  - **Current District & State:** Chengalpattu District, Tamil Nadu
  - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sthalasayana Perumal Temple, Mahabalipuram.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
  - **Divine Amsam:** Kaustubham (The auspicious, celestial gem residing on Sriman Narayana's chest)
  - **Historical Period:** Early Sangam / Post-Sangam Transition Period (c. 5th–6th Century CE).
  - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Poigai Azhwar, Pey Azhwar, Pallava Dynasty Kings (who developed the port city of Mallai).

## Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

### 2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Ayoni Sambhava Birth:** Discovered inside a Liquorice (*Kurukkatthi* / Madhavi) flower in Thirukadalmallai → **Divine Infusion:** Imbibing the name *Bhoothath* (one filled with the

intense, intoxicated love for the Divine) → **Thirukoilur Convergence:** Gathering with Poigai and Pey Azhwar in the dark corridor → **Lighting the Lamp of Love:** Composition of *Irاندam Thiruvanthadhi* starting with *Anbe Thagaliyaga* → **Perpetual Pilgrimage:** Continuous propagation of Bhakti through song across sacred shrines → **Ascension:** Attainment of eternal service (*Nitya Kainkaryam*) at the feet of the Divine Couple.

## 2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Like Poigai Azhwar, Bhoothath Azhwar was an *Ayoni Sambhava*. He manifested inside the blossom of a *Kurukkatthi* vine (Licorice plant) in a garden near the seashore at Thirukadalmallai (modern Mahabalipuram). The name *Bhoothath* is derived from the word *Bhootha*, signifying one who is completely consumed, possessed, or intoxicated by *Bhakti* (divine love) for Srīman Narayana. Free from all worldly attachments from birth, he spent his youth wandering along the coast, continuously chanting the names of Narayana.
- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** Bhoothath Azhwar's unique service was the conversion of intellectual realization (*Jnana*) into emotional, nectar-like devotion (*Bhakti*). He transformed formal Vedic theology into felt, experiential loving service (*Preema-Rasa*).
- **Miracles & Historical Events:** During the thunderous night at Thirukoilur, after Poigai Azhwar lit the physical/cosmic lamp with the Sun as its wick (*Vaiyam Thagaliyaga*), Bhoothath Azhwar realized that a material lamp alone could not illuminate the internal form of the Supreme Lord who stood among them. Inspired by divine grace, he lit an internal, emotional lamp. He declared love (*Anbu*) to be the lamp bowl, intense longing (*Aarvam*) to be the ghee, and a mind melted in bliss (*Sinthaī*) to be the burning wick. Through this *Anbu Deepam* (Lamp of Love), he brought warmth and emotional clarity to the divine revelation occurring in the corridor.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Functioned in absolute spiritual harmony with Poigai and Pey Azhwar. The trio acted as a single collective spiritual unit, laying the foundational triad of Sri Vaishnava theology.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Having illuminated the inner emotional pathway to Narayana through his 100 verses, Bhoothath Azhwar merged into the eternal abode (*Paramapadam*), leaving behind his *Prabandham* as an imperishable guide for posterity.

### 💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: Sthalasayana Perumal & Mallai Connection**

Thirukadalmallai is uniquely associated with the Lord reclining on the ground (*Sthalasayana*). Legend states that sage Pundarika offered lotus flowers directly to the Lord's feet here, and the Lord assumed a reclining posture on the bare earth to receive them. Bhoothath Azhwar's presence in this shrine reinforced the profound accessibility (*Saulabhya*) of Narayana, who lie down on the simple earth out of love for His devotee.

## Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
  - *Tamil Works: Irاندam Thiruvanthadhi* (100 Pasurams in *Venba* meter).
  - *Philosophical Impact:* Introduced the emotional depth of *Raganuga Bhakti* (passionate

devotion) into formal Viśiṣṭādvaita jurisprudence.

- **Quantified Output:** 100 Pasurams composed in strict Andhadhi meter.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Thirukadalmallai (Mahabalipuram), Thirukoilur, Thirumirailai (Mylapore), Thiruvengadam (Tirupati), Thirukudanthai (Kumbakonam), Thirukottiyur, Sri Rangam.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Clarified that intellectual knowledge (*Jnana*) is incomplete without emotional surrender (*Bhakti*). He protected the sampradaya from cold, intellectual stoicism by demonstrating that love is the ultimate medium to perceive God.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Priti-Garbha Bhakti** (Love-infused devotion). His core doctrine emphasizes that God is conquered not by austere penance alone, but by pure, unblemished affection (*Anbu*).

## Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

### Verse 1: Irandam Thiruvanthadhi, Pasuram 1 (*Anbe Thagaliyaga*)

| Text Layer                       | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Original Script ( <i>Tamil</i> ) | அன்பே தகளியா ஆர்வம் நெய்யாக<br>இன்புருகு சிந்தை இடுதிரியா -<br>நன்புருகி<br>ஞானச் சுடர்விளக் கேற்றினேன்<br>நாரணற்கு<br>ஞானத் தமிழ் புரிந்த நான்                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Roman Transliteration            | <i>Anbe thagaliyaga aarvam neyyaga</i><br><i>Inburugu sinthai iduthiriyaa - nanburugi</i><br><i>Jnana sudar vilakkerttinen Naranarku</i><br><i>Jnana thamizh purintha naan</i>                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Literal Word-by-Word Meaning     | <b>Anbe:</b> Love/Devotion; <b>Thagaliyaga:</b> as the lamp bowl; <b>Aarvam:</b> intense desire/longing; <b>Neyyaga:</b> as the clarifying ghee; <b>Inburugu:</b> melting in divine bliss; <b>Sinthai:</b> the mind/thought; <b>Iduthiriyaa:</b> as the placed wick; <b>Nanburugi:</b> with a soul deeply melted in affection; <b>Jnana sudar vilakku:</b> the |



|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <p>luminous lamp of spiritual wisdom;<br/> <b>Erttinen:</b> I have lit; <b>Naranarku:</b> for Lord Narayana; <b>Jnana thamizh purintha naan:</b> I who have authored this wisdom-filled Tamil literature.</p> |
|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopo Jnanam):** Bhoothath Azhwar complements Poigai Azhwar's external cosmic lamp with an internal, subjective lamp. The physical universe is useless to see God unless the human heart possesses the requisite emotional ingredients: love (*Anbu*), eagerness (*Aarvam*), and a mind softened by divine contemplation (*Sintha*).
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Demonstrates the essential relationship between *Bhakti* and *Jnana*. In Viśiṣṭādvaita, *Bhakti* is defined as *Tailadhara-vat avicchinnā smṛiti-santana-rupa* (unbroken recollection of God like a continuous stream of oil). The "ghee" (*Aarvam*) represents this unbroken continuity of devotional focus required to fuel the flame of divine knowledge.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Nampillai notes that while Poigai Azhwar provided the *Swaroopo Jnanam* (awareness of divine reality), Bhoothath Azhwar provided the *Rasa* (taste/sweetness) without which spiritual knowledge remains dry. The phrase *Jnana Thamizh* establishes Tamil as a sacred language capable of conveying the deepest *Vedic* insights.

## Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

### 5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Seated in *Padmasana* or standing alongside Poigai Azhwar in a posture of devotional ecstasy.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Hands held in *Anjali Mudra* (folded in prayer) close to the chest, symbolizing emotional surrender.
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Dressed in ascetic garments, adorned with *Rudra/Tulasi* garlands, featuring prominent *Urdhva Pundra* tilak markings across his arms, chest, and forehead.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** At Thirukadalmallai (Mahabalipuram), his image is consecrated in a dedicated shrine, depicting him with a joyful demeanor reflecting his name (*Bhoothath*—intoxicated by divine love).

### 5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Bhoothath Azhwar Irandam Thiruvanthadhi Lecture Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Anbe Thagaliyaga Pasuram Detailed Vyakhyanam Karunakarachariar"
- "Mudhal Azhwargal Life History Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

### 5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** [<http://www.dravidaveda.org>](<http://www.dravidaveda.org>)

- **Project Madurai Texts:**  
[<https://www.projectmadurai.org>](<https://www.projectmadurai.org>)
- **Koyil Archival Library:** [<https://koyil.org>](<https://koyil.org>)

### 3. PEY AZHWAR

(*Thirumayilai Avathara Mudhal Azhwar, Mahadahvaya, Peyar*)

#### Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Pey Azhwar, Mahadahvaya, Peyar (The Divinely Possessed Saint), Third among the Mudhal Azhwars.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
  - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Aippasi
  - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Sadayam (Shatabhisha)
  - **Tithi & Paksham:** Dvapara Yuga terminal phase (Two days after Poigai Azhwar), Sukla Paksha Ekadashi.
- **Geographic Origins:**
  - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Thirumayilai (Mylapore, Chennai)
  - **Current District & State:** Chennai District, Tamil Nadu
  - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Sri Adi Kesava Perumal Temple, Mylapore, Chennai.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
  - **Divine Amsam:** Nandaka (The Divine Sword of Sriman Narayana)
  - **Historical Period:** Early Sangam / Post-Sangam Transition Period (c. 5th–6th Century CE).
  - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Poigai Azhwar, Bhoothath Azhwar, Thirumazhisai Azhwar (his illustrious disciple).

#### Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

##### 2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Ayoni Sambhava Birth:** Discovered in a red lily (*Sevvali*) flower inside the temple tank of Adi Kesava Perumal Temple, Mylapore → **Ecstatic State:** Attaining the state of *Pey* (divine madness/possession) through unceasing visualization of the Lord → **Climax at Thirukoilur:** Direct vision of the Divine Couple (*Sri and Narayana*) in the illuminated dark corridor → **Composition of Moondram Thiruvanthadhi:** Commencing with the historic proclamation *Thirukanden Pon Meni Kanden* → **Mentorship of Thirumazhisai:** Guiding Thirumazhisai Azhwar into the fold of Sriman Narayana → **Eternal Bliss:** Merging into the divine realm of Sri Vaikuntham.

##### 2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Pey Azhwar was the third *Ayoni Sambhava* saint, born inside a red lily flower in the Manikairavam well/tank of the Adi Kesava Perumal Temple in Mylapore, Chennai. The name *Pey* in Tamil translates literally to "ghost" or "one possessed." He was given this epithet because his external behavior resembled that of a madman—he would laugh uncontrollably, cry, dance, and break into sudden song, completely oblivious to social norms, because his mind was perpetually fixated on the transcendent beauty of God.

- **Core Seva / Kainkaryam:** His primary contribution was revealing the **Prathyaksha Anubhava** (direct, immediate ocular vision) of Sriman Narayana accompanied by His eternal consort, Sri Lakshmi (*Thiru*).
- **Miracles & Historical Events:** The Thirukoilur corridor encounter reached its grand climax through Pey Azhwar. When Poigai Azhwar lit the outer cosmic lamp (*Jnana*) and Bhoothath Azhwar lit the inner emotional lamp (*Bhakti*), the pitch-black corridor was flooded with divine illumination. Pey Azhwar, standing as the third person, turned his eyes toward the mysterious fourth presence and experienced direct divine vision (*Saksatkara*). He saw not just Narayana alone, but Sri Lakshmi (*Thiru*) residing eternally on His golden chest. Overwhelmed by this vision, he burst into the ecstatic declaration: "*Thirukanden Pon Meni Kanden!*" ("I have seen Lakshmi! I have seen the Golden Form!").
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics:** Pey Azhwar served as the revered spiritual preceptor (Acharya) to Thirumazhisai Azhwar. When Thirumazhisai was practicing austere Saivite/Siddhanta penance, Pey Azhwar famously planted a plant upside down and watered a dry, dead stick to draw his attention. When Thirumazhisai questioned this absurd behavior, Pey Azhwar replied that seeking liberation from deities other than Sriman Narayana was even more absurd. This encounter transformed Thirumazhisai into an unyielding devotee of Narayana.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam:** Having transmitted his divine vision and established the unbroken lineage (*Guru Parampara*) through Thirumazhisai Azhwar, Pey Azhwar ascended to Paramapadam.

💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: The Revelation of Purushakara Tattva**  
 Pey Azhwar's revelation at Thirukoilur is theological cornerstone of Sri Vaishnavism. By seeing *Thiru* (Sri Lakshmi) first (*Thirukanden*), he established that Narayana is never approached in isolation, but always as *Divya Dampathi* (The Divine Couple). Lakshmi acts as the indispensable mediatrix (*Purushakara*), ensuring that the Lord's justice is tempered by supreme grace.

### Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works:**
  - *Tamil Works: Moondram Thiruvanthadhi* (100 Pasurams in *Venba* meter).
  - *Theological Impact:* Establishes the doctrine of *Sridharatvam* (the Lord defined by His connection to Sri).
- **Quantified Output:** 100 Pasurams composed in strict *Andhadhi* meter.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam):** Thirumayilai (Mylapore), Thirukoilur, Thiruvengadam (Tirupati), Thiruvallikeni (Triplicane), Thirukudanthai, Sri Rangan.
- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Formulated the primary Sri Vaishnava identity: God is Sriman Narayana—Narayana irrevocably united with Sri (Lakshmi). He safeguarded the sampradaya from doctrines that worshiped the Absolute without its inherent mercy aspect (*Krupa*).
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Saksatkara Bhakti / Darsana Bhava** (Devotion culminating in direct vision). His work highlights *Purushakara Prapatti* (Surrender to God through the divine Mother).

## Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

### Verse 1: Moondram Thiruvanthadhi, Pasuram 1 (*Thirukanden Pon Meni Kanden*)

| Text Layer                       | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Original Script ( <i>Tamil</i> ) | திருக்கண்டேன் பொன்மேனி<br>கண்டேன் - திகழும்<br><br>அருக்கனிறம் போன்றும் உருவும் -<br>செருக்கிளறும்<br><br>பொன்னாழி கண்டேன் புரிசங்கம்<br>கைக்கண்டேன்<br><br>என்னாழி வண்ணன்பால் இன்று                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Roman Transliteration            | <i>Thirukanden pon meni kanden - thigazhum</i><br><br><i>Arukkanniram pondrum uruvum -<br/>serukkilarum</i><br><br><i>Ponnazhi kanden puri sangam kai kanden</i><br><br><i>Ennazhi vannan pal indru</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Literal Word-by-Word Meaning     | <b>Thirukanden:</b> I have beheld Goddess Sri Lakshmi; <b>Pon meni kanden:</b> I have beheld His radiant golden body; <b>Thigazhum:</b> dazzling/glorious; <b>Arukkan niram pondrum:</b> resembling the hue of the brilliant sun; <b>Uruvum:</b> His form; <b>Serukilarum:</b> fierce and victorious; <b>Pon azhi kanden:</b> I have beheld the golden Discus (Sudarshana); <b>Puri sangam:</b> the spiraled Conch (Panchajanya); <b>Kai kanden:</b> I have seen in His hands; <b>En azhi vannan pal:</b> in my Lord who possesses the deep hue of the ocean; <b>Indru:</b> today. |

#### Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

- Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopa Jnanam):** The verse represents the absolute summit of

spiritual perception. The order of perception is critical: Pey Azhwar sees *Thiru* (Lakshmi) first, because it is Her presence on the chest of Narayana that grants the Lord His captivating *Golden Form* (*Pon Meni*) and converts His awesome power into accessible grace.

2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment:** Substantiates the *Sishya-Gati* (path of the soul). The presence of the Weapons—the Discus (*Azhi*) and Conch (*Sangam*)—demonstrates that the Lord is fully equipped to destroy the *Karmic* obstacles of those who take refuge in Him through Lakshmi's mediation.
3. **Commentarial Insights:** Periyavachan Pillai emphasizes the word *Indru* ("Today"). It signifies that after countless births spent in the darkness of *Samsara*, this moment of divine vision is the true beginning of the soul's existence. The golden color (*Pon Meni*) represents the amalgamation of divine beauty (*Thirumeni*) illuminated by the presence of Sri.

## Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

### 5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana):** Standing or seated in an ecstatic pose, often depicted with eyes wide in wonder and arms raised in joyous expression.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras):** Hands pointing toward the Lord or held in *Anjali Mudra* with an expression of visual ecstasy (*Prathyaksha Anubhava*).
- **Garments & Embellishments:** Simple ascetic wear, marked heavily with *Urdhva Pundra* (holy tilak), adorned with *Tulasi* garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description:** Located at the Sri Adi Kesava Perumal Temple in Mylapore, Chennai. The *Moolavar* idol depicts Pey Azhwar in his characteristic state of divine enchantment, gazing directly at the Lord's form.

### 5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Pey Azhwar Moondram Thiruvanthadhi Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Thirukanden Pon Meni Kanden Meaning Karunakarachariar"
- "Pey Azhwar Life and Thirumazhisai Interaction Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

### 5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository:** [<http://www.dravidaveda.org>](<http://www.dravidaveda.org>)
- **Project Madurai Texts:** [<https://www.projectmadurai.org>](<https://www.projectmadurai.org>)
- **Koyil Archival Library:** [<https://koyil.org>](<https://koyil.org>)

## 4. THIRUMAZHISAI AZHWAR

(*Bhaktisara, Thirumazhisai Piran, Mazhisai Vandhar, Kanchipuram Kanikannan Patron*)

### Section 1: Identification & Incarnation Details

- **Full Name & Titles:** Thirumazhisai Azhwar, Bhaktisara, Thirumazhisai Piran, Mazhisai Vendhan, Urayil Idaiyittar.
- **Incarnation Metadata:**
  - **Tamil Month (Maasam):** Thai (Makaram)
  - **Birth Star (Nakshatram):** Magham

- **Tithi & Paksham:** Dvapara Yuga; Sukla Paksha Saptami.
- **Geographic Origins:**
  - **Historic Birthplace Name:** Thirumazhisai (Jagannatha Kshetram)
  - **Current District & State:** Thiruvallur District, Tamil Nadu
  - **Associated Divya Desam / Temple:** Jagannatha Perumal Temple, Thirumazhisai; Yathothkari Perumal Temple, Kanchipuram; Kumbakonam Sarangapani Temple.
- **Divine Lineage & Era:**
  - **Divine Amsam:** Sudarshana Chakra (The Divine Discus/Wheel of Sriman Narayana)
  - **Historical Period:** c. 6th–7th Century CE.
  - **Sovereign & Scholarly Contemporaries:** Pey Azhwar (His Acharya), Kanikannan (His primary disciple), Pallava King (Traditional accounts identify him with King Mahendravarman I).

## Section 2: Complete Life History & Miracles

### 2.1 Chronological Life Timeline

- **Fetal Manifestation & Discovery:** Born as an unformed mass of flesh to Sage Bhargava and Kanakangi; miraculously transformed into a complete child by Divine Grace and nurtured by the bamboo-cutter Perumban and his wife → **Philosophical Exploration:** Rigorous study and practice of Buddhism, Jainism, Shaivism (taking the name *Sivavakkyar*) → **Reconversion by Pey Azhwar:** The miraculous upside-down plant incident leading to his total surrender to Sriman Narayana → **The Kanchi Exodus:** Ordering Lord Yathothkari Perumal to fold His serpent bed and leave Kanchipuram when King banished Kanikannan → **The Kumbakonam Years:** Reclining the Sarangapani deity (*Keddakidandha Ennayya*) at Kumbakonam → **Ascension:** Merging into the holy body of Lord Sarangapani.

### 2.2 Deep Biographical Narrative

- **Early Years & Spiritual Awakening:** Sage Bhargava performed a great sacrifice (*Yajna*). His wife Kanakangi gave birth prematurely to a lifeless, limbless mass of flesh. Overcome with grief, they placed it at the base of a cane bush in the forest of Thirumazhisai. Through the grace of Sriman Narayana, the mass transformed into a glowing, beautiful infant boy. A woodcutter named Perumban and his wife Pankajavalli discovered the child and raised him with deep love. The child famously refused to take any material nourishment for years until an elderly, pious couple offered him fresh milk daily. In gratitude, the child allowed the couple to drink the remaining milk, which restored their youth and blessed them with a son named Kanikannan, who became Thirumazhisai's lifelong disciple.
- **Core Seva / Kaikaryam:** Establishing absolute, uncompromising monotheism (*Parathvam* of Narayana) through intense logical debate, deep scriptural analysis, and polemical literature (*Nanmugan Thiruvanthadhi*).
- **Miracles & Historical Events:**
  1. *The Transformation of Sivavakkyar:* In his search for the ultimate truth, he thoroughly mastered Jainism, Buddhism, and Shaivism, adopting the name *Sivavakkyar*. Pey Azhwar intercepted him in Kanchipuram, planting a stick upside down and watering it with a

broken pot. When Sivavakkyar questioned this folly, Pey Azhwar demonstrated that seeking salvation through any entity other than Narayana was equally futile. Convinced by Pey Azhwar's profound philosophical exposition, he embraced Sri Vaishnavism and earned the title *Bhaktisara* (the essence of devotion).

2. *The Departure of Yathothkari Perumal*: In Kanchipuram, an elderly maid who served Thirumazhisai was blessed with youth through his grace. The local Pallava King married her and, desiring eternal youth for himself, demanded that Kanikannan bring Thirumazhisai to his court. Kanikannan refused, stating that his guru sung praises only of God, not mortal men. The enraged King banished Kanikannan. When Kanikannan informed Thirumazhisai, the saint decided to leave as well, refusing to stay where his disciple was insulted. Approaching the local temple, Thirumazhisai commanded the deity: *"Kanikannan is leaving, I too am going! You too fold your serpent bed (Adisesha) and roll up your divine sleep!"* Uniquely in temple history, the Supreme Lord (*Yathothkari*) obeyed the saint, folded His bed, and followed them out of Kanchipuram. Darkness and despair fell upon the kingdom. Realizing his grave error, the King rushed to apologize. Thirumazhisai relented and commanded the Lord to return: *"Kanikannan has returned, I too have returned! Roll out your serpent bed!"* The Lord complied, earning the eternal title **Yathothkari** (The One who obeyed His devotee's command / *Sonna Vannam Seitha Perumal*).
3. *Interacting with Lord Sarangapani at Kumbakonam*: Arriving at Kumbakonam, Thirumazhisai stood before Lord Aravamudhan (Sarangapani) and sang: *"Are your legs aching from walking so long? Rise up and speak to me!"* The giant reclining deity actually began to rise from his serpent bed. Astounded, Thirumazhisai prayed: *"Please stay as you are, do not rise further!"* The Lord remained frozen in a half-rising posture (*Uthana Sayana*), which can be witnessed at Kumbakonam to this day.
- **Guru-Disciple Dynamics**: Disciple of Pey Azhwar; Guru to Kanikannan. Their relationship represents the absolute pinnacle of Acharya-Sishya affection.
- **Attainment of Paramapadam**: Spent his final years in deep contemplation (*Samadhi*) at Kumbakonam, eventually merging directly into the deity of Lord Sarangapani.

💡 **Sthala Puranam & Legend Highlight: Sonna Vannam Seitha Perumal**

The miracle at Tiruvekka highlights a fundamental Viśiṣṭādvaita concept:

**Aasrita-Pardhanthriyam** (The Lord willing subjection to His true devotees). The Supreme Sovereign of the Cosmos became a follower of His saint's command, demonstrating that love (*Bhakti*) grants the devotee complete sway over God.

### Section 3: Literary, Preservation & Philosophical Contributions

- **Complete List of Works**:
  - *Nanmugan Thiruvanthadhi* (96 Pasurams) – A rigorous, polemical text establishing Narayana as the ultimate source of Brahma (Nanmugan), Shiva, and all creation.
  - *Thiruchanda Viruttham* (120 Pasurams) – A masterpiece of rhythmic, metrical Tamil poetry blending complex mathematical rhythms with profound Upanishadic concepts.
- **Quantified Output**: 216 Pasurams total.
- **Associated Divya Desams (Mangalasasanam)**: Thirumazhisai, Tiruvekka (Kanchipuram),

Thirukudanthai (Kumbakonam), Thiruvengadam (Tirupati), Thiruvallikeni, Thirukotiyur, Anbil, Sri Rangam.

- **Sampradaya Defense & Preservation:** Functioned as the fiercest defender of Vaishnava monotheism. He systematically refuted non-Vedic and rival sectarian philosophies, establishing an unshakeable intellectual foundation for Viśiṣṭādvaita.
- **Predominant Bhakti Bhava & Philosophical Core: Ekantha / Nirupadhika Bhakti** (Uncompromising, absolute devotion to Narayana alone). He strictly prohibited *Adevatha-Upasana* (worship of lesser gods).

## Section 4: Representative Verses & Theological Breakdown

### Verse 1: Nanmugan Thiruvanthadhi, Pasuram 1 (*Nanmuganai Narayanan Padaitthan*)

| Text Layer                       | Content                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Original Script ( <i>Tamil</i> ) | நான்முகனை நாரணன் படைத்தான்<br>நான்முகனும்<br><br>தான்முகமாய் சங்கரனைத்<br>தான்படைத்தான் - யான்முகமாய்<br><br>அந்தாதி மேலிட்டு அறிவித்தேன்<br>ஆழ்பொருளை<br><br>சிந்தாமை கொண்மின் திருது                                                                                                                                      |
| Roman Transliteration            | <i>Nanmuganai Narayanan padaitthan</i><br><i>Nanmuganum</i><br><br><i>Than mugamai Sangaranai than padaitthan</i><br><i>- yan mugamai</i><br><br><i>Andhadhi melittu arivits then aazh porulai</i><br><br><i>Sinthamai konmin thiridhu</i>                                                                                  |
| Literal Word-by-Word Meaning     | <b>Nanmuganai:</b> The four-faced Brahma;<br><b>Narayanan:</b> Lord Narayana; <b>Padaitthan:</b> created; <b>Nanmuganum:</b> and that four-faced Brahma; <b>Than mugamai:</b> in turn through his own agency; <b>Sangaranai:</b> Lord Shankara (Shiva); <b>Than padaitthan:</b> created; <b>Yan mugamai:</b> I, taking this |



|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | responsibility; <b>Andhadhi melittu</b> : using the Anthadhi poetic meter; <b>Arivitsthen</b> : have declared; <b>Aazh porulai</b> : this deep, profound esoteric truth; <b>Sinthamai konmin</b> : hold it firmly in your mind without letting it slip; <b>Thiridhu</b> : without doubt or confusion. |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Exhaustive Theological & Philosophical Commentary:

1. **Esoteric Meaning (Swaroopa Jnanam)**: Thirumazhisai Azhwar lays down the precise cosmic hierarchy (*Tattva Sekhara*). Narayana is the primordial Cause (*Karna Parabrahma*). From Narayana's navel lotus emerged Brahma (*Nanmugan*), and from Brahma was born Shiva (*Sankaran*). Therefore, Narayana alone is the ultimate source and salvation.
2. **Viśiṣṭādvaita Alignment**: Direct Tamil translation of the Upanishadic dictum: "*Eko ha vai Narayana aaseet, na Brahma na Ishana...*" (Narayana alone existed in the beginning, neither Brahma nor Shiva). It establishes *Karanatvam* (Causality) as the primary definition of the Supreme Absolute (*Brahman*).
3. **Commentarial Insights**: Periyavachan Pillai notes that the saint opens his work with this unequivocal declaration to spare humanity from wasting their lives worshipping intermediate deities (*Devatantara*). He commands seekers to hold this truth *Sinthamai* (without spilling/losing), treating it as precious nectar.

## Section 5: Visuals & Archival Resources

### 5.1 Iconography & Shrine Visual Description

- **Physical Posture (Asana)**: Seated in *Yoga Asana* or *Padmasana*, exhibiting intense spiritual power.
- **Hand Gestures (Mudras)**: Right hand held in *Jnana Mudra* or *Upadesha Mudra*, left hand resting on his knee; occasionally portrayed with an eye on his right big toe (referencing the legend where he opened a third eye on his foot to overpower a celestial rival's heat).
- **Garments & Embellishments**: Dressed in ascetic robes, marked prominently with twelve *Urdhva Pundra* (Holy Clay Tilak) marks, adorned with sacred thread (*Yajnopavitam*) and *Tulasi* garlands.
- **Avathara Sthalam Idol Description**: At his birth shrine in Thirumazhisai, his *Moolavar* idol radiates monumental yogic energy, capturing his authority as *Bhaktisara*—the essence of devotion.

### 5.2 Academic Audio/Video Lecture Queries

- "Thirumazhisai Azhwar Life History Velukkudi Krishnan"
- "Nanmugan Thiruvanthadhi Pasuram 1 Vyakhyanam Karunakarachariar"
- "Thiruchanda Viruttham Upanyasam Ananthapadmanabhachariar"

### 5.3 Digital Text & Archival Links

- **Dravida Veda Repository**: [<http://www.dravidaveda.org>](<http://www.dravidaveda.org>)

- **Project Madurai Texts:**  
[<https://www.projectmadurai.org>](<https://www.projectmadurai.org>)
- **Koyil Archival Library:** [<https://koyil.org>](<https://koyil.org>)